

EIC SCHOOL · ADULT B2+ · PART 1 OF 2

The Invisible Hand

Causative verbs & passive voice · Question formation

Read the text. Build your questions using the clues in parentheses. The bracketed notes identify each grammar structure.

Student

Date

THE TEXT

Every morning, before Nara opens her eyes, the algorithm has already **had her feed curated** [*have something done*]. By the time she reaches for her phone, **a version of the world has been assembled for her** [*present perfect passive*]: the products she is likely to want, the opinions she is likely to find persuasive, the people whose lives will **make her feel** [*make + bare inf.*] behind. She did not ask for this. She does not refuse it either.

The system does not **make Nara do** [*make + bare inf.*] anything in the way that a command does. It works more quietly than that. It **gets her to want** [*get + to + inf.*] things she did not know she lacked. A bag she never needed becomes, after fourteen impressions, something she feels she has been missing. **Her desire has been manufactured** [*present perfect passive*] for her so smoothly that the manufacturing is invisible.

Bernays understood this a hundred years ago. He **got an entire generation to associate** [*get + to + inf.*] cigarettes with freedom. He did not lie, exactly. He simply placed the right objects in the hands of the right people and **let the public believe** [*let + bare inf.*] that the desire was their own. The technique has not changed. Only the medium has.

Huxley saw the endpoint. In his World State, citizens **are not forced** [*present simple passive*] into happiness — they **have their happiness designed for them** [*have something done*] before they are born. The conditioning is so complete that the question of freedom never arises. **Soma makes them feel** [*make + bare inf.*] exactly what the system needs them to feel. No one refuses. There is nothing to refuse against.

This is what Zuboff calls behavioural modification at scale. The platform does not punish the wrong choices — **it makes the wrong choices seem** [*make + bare inf.*] unthinkable. It **gets you to stay** [*get + to + inf.*] not through walls but through a variable reward schedule that your nervous system was never designed to resist.

Nara has never thought of herself as someone who **lets the system decide** [*let + bare inf.*] what she wants. She thinks of herself as someone with taste, with preferences, with a carefully considered sense of who she is. And she is right, in a way. The preferences are real. The question is only: who **had them designed** [*have something done*]?

A cage that makes you love it [*make + bare inf.*] is still a cage. It is simply a better one.

CAUSATIVE QUESTIONS

1 The algorithm _____ (*what*) for Nara before she opens her eyes.

2 The system does not use commands — how does it _____ (*get Nara to do what*)?

3 Who _____ (*got what group to do what*) a hundred years ago?

4 How did Bernays _____ (*let the public do what*) — without lying?

5 Citizens have their happiness designed _____ (*when*) and _____ (*by whom*)?

6 How does the platform _____ (*get you to do what*) — without walls?

7 Why has Nara never thought of herself as someone who _____ (*lets what happen*)?

8 Who _____ (*had what done*) — if not Nara herself?

PASSIVE VOICE QUESTIONS

1 By the time Nara reaches for her phone, _____ (*what*) has been assembled for her.

2 How _____ (*has Nara's desire been treated*) — so that even the manufacturing is invisible?

3 Why _____ (*are citizens not forced*) into happiness in the World State?

4 According to Huxley, what kind of cage _____ (*is the system described as*)?

BEFORE PART TWO

Five questions of concept.

No correct answer. Take a position and defend it. Read the philosophical context before writing.

01 Is desire that was engineered still genuine — or does its origin change what it is?

*genuinely yours is not where it came from, but whether you endorse it at a
Huxley disagrees implicitly: if the endorsement itself was engineered, the*

02 The text argues the system works through persuasion, not force. Does that distinction matter morally?

*is more democratic than coercion because it respected the appearance of
the seductive illusion of all: a cage that persuades you to enter is harder to*

03 Huxley's citizens are not forced — they are designed to love what the system needs them to love. Is that a form of freedom, or its opposite?

*is argued explicitly that the most insidious tyranny is one that feels like
a tyrant who refuses it — choosing suffering over engineered happiness.
the only human choice available.*

04 If resistance always gets absorbed by the system — turned into a brand, a lifestyle, a market — does that mean resistance is pointless?

*the system is, infinitely plastic entity, capable of metabolizing and absorbing
resistance becomes a clothing line. Environmentalism becomes a product
of the system — only that it must operate at the level of imagination, not*

05 Is it possible to want something that the system did not, in some way, put there first?

*is a displaced symbol of something the culture makes available. Frankfurt's
desire is not a desire and genuinely endorse it as your own, its causal origin
is not the system itself is a product of the culture that shaped you.*